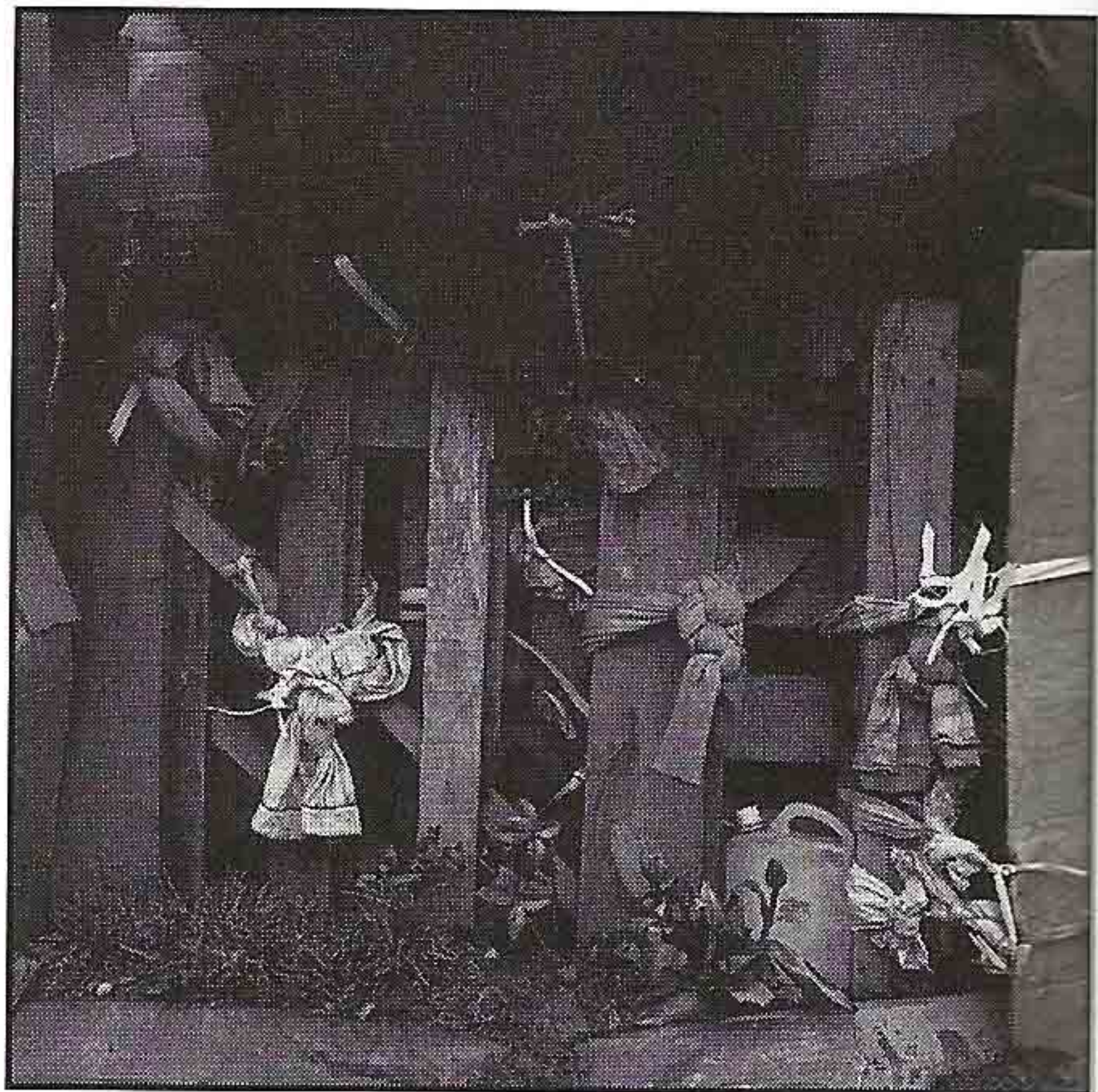
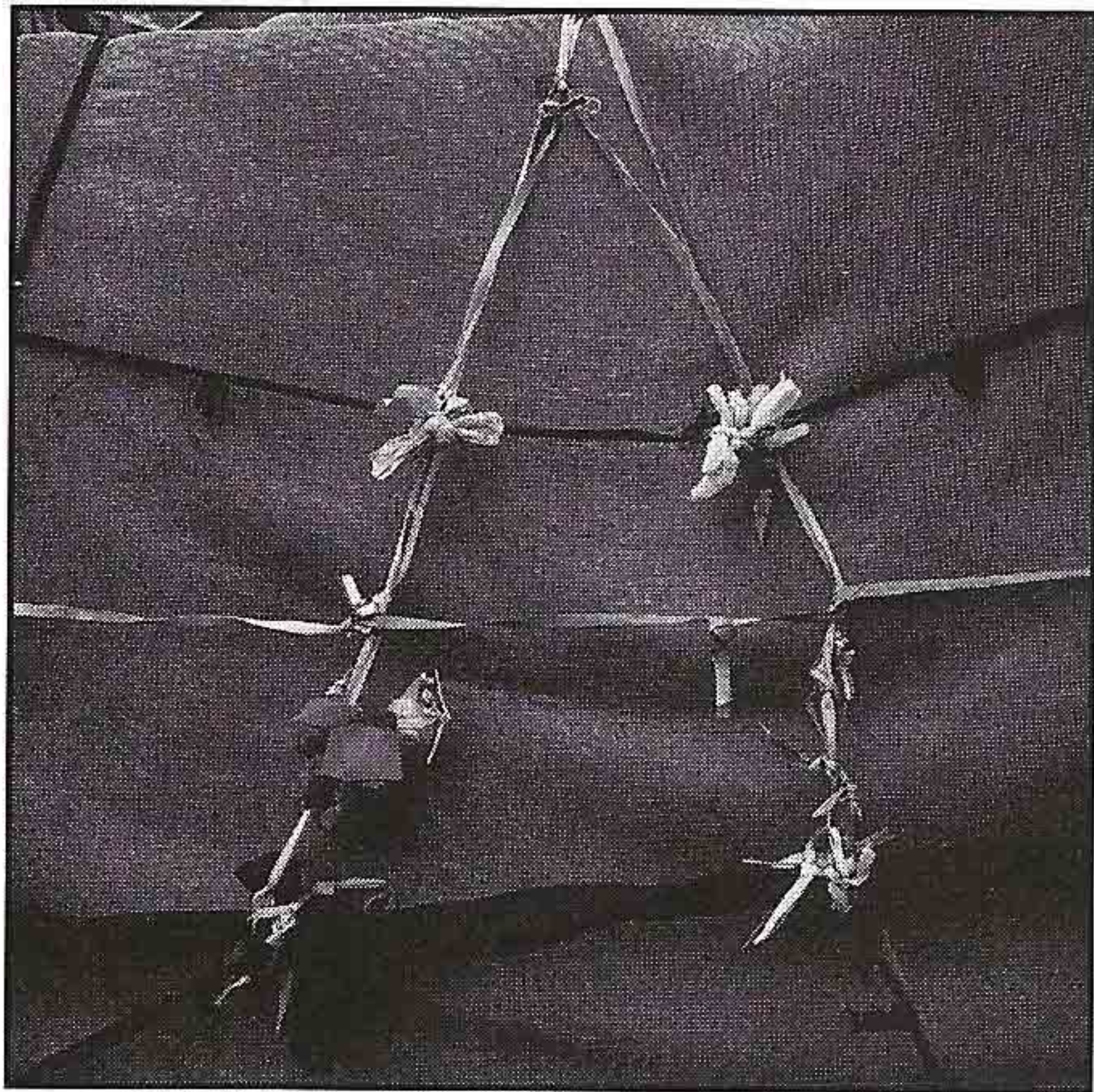
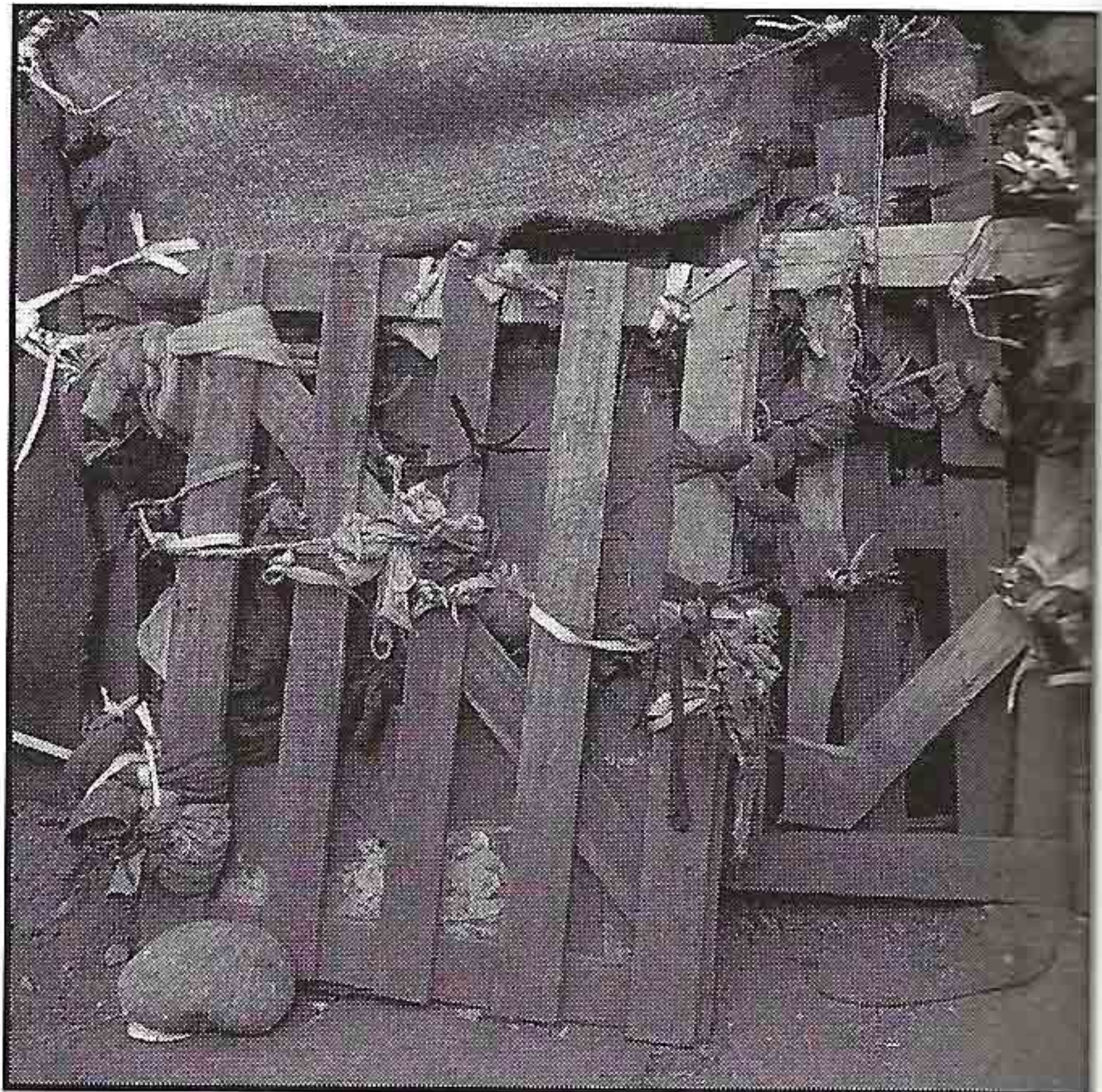
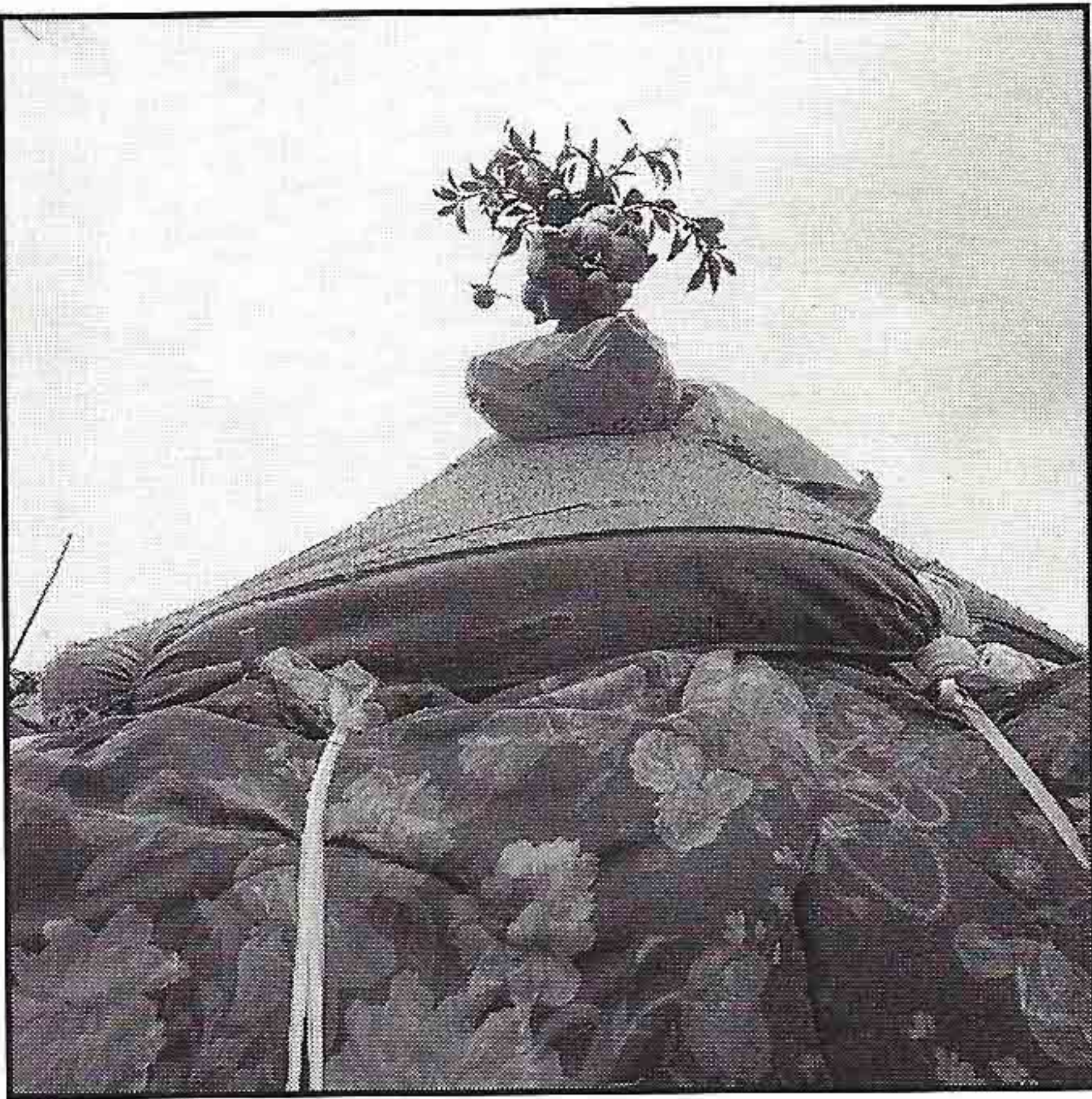


Memories of Mr. Lee

1930-1992

Margaret Morton





Mr. Lee's house was his own unique creation. Built without a single nail, it was held together with knotted, brightly colored ropes and industrial plastic. Every morning at dawn, he could be seen writing on pieces of cardboard with Chinese characters—messages that he would tie into the structure of his house. After carefully placing a rock outside the knot-hinged, wooden skid-door that marked his entrance, Mr. Lee would throw two burlap rice sacks over his shoulder, and walk the streets of New York City's Chinatown, stopping occasionally to collect things that others had discarded. At dusk, he would return, and unpack his treasures tying them to the outside of his house. Mr. Lee's solitary life revolved around the creation and ongoing recreation of his home.

On May 29th, 1992, an arsonist set fire to Mr. Lee's home. He was killed in the flames. Later, his friends stood in the ashes of his home and promised him that the knots he had tied would create new bonds forever.

